USER GUIDE

DataForge AI

Ask your business data anything. This guide walks you through every screen, step by step, with a picture of each page.

Version 0.1.0 · **Environment** Local development

Web app http://localhost:3000 · **Updated** October 2026

OVERVIEW

What is DataForge AI?

DataForge AI is a secure workspace for asking questions of your business data. It answers with read-only SQL over your connected databases and cites the documents behind every result. Access is scoped to your organization and role, and every AI run is recorded in an audit log.

1 · Start the application	Terminal
2 · Sign in	Page 1
3 · Dashboard	Page 2
4 · AI Analyst	Page 3
5 · Data Sources	Page 4
6 · Documents	Page 5
7 · Executions	Page 6
8 · Execution detail	Page 7
9 · Users & Roles	Page 8
10 · Audit Logs	Page 9
11 · Settings	Page 10
12 · On mobile	Page 11

Before you begin

- **Docker Desktop** installed and running.
- The repository checked out locally, with a **.env** file at its root.
- An account in your organization (or the seeded development logins below).

Development sign-in. If you seeded the development data, sign in as **owner@dataforge.local** with the password **DataForge!Dev1**. The same password works for **admin@**, **analyst@** and **viewer@dataforge.local**.

1 STEP ONE

Start the application

The whole stack runs with Docker Compose. On Windows, double-click **START.bat** in the repository root — a console window opens, starts all six services and waits until they are ready.

SERVICE	URL
Web application	`http://localhost:3000`
API root	`http://localhost:8000`
API health	`http://localhost:8000/_health/`
AI service health	`http://localhost:8001/_health/`

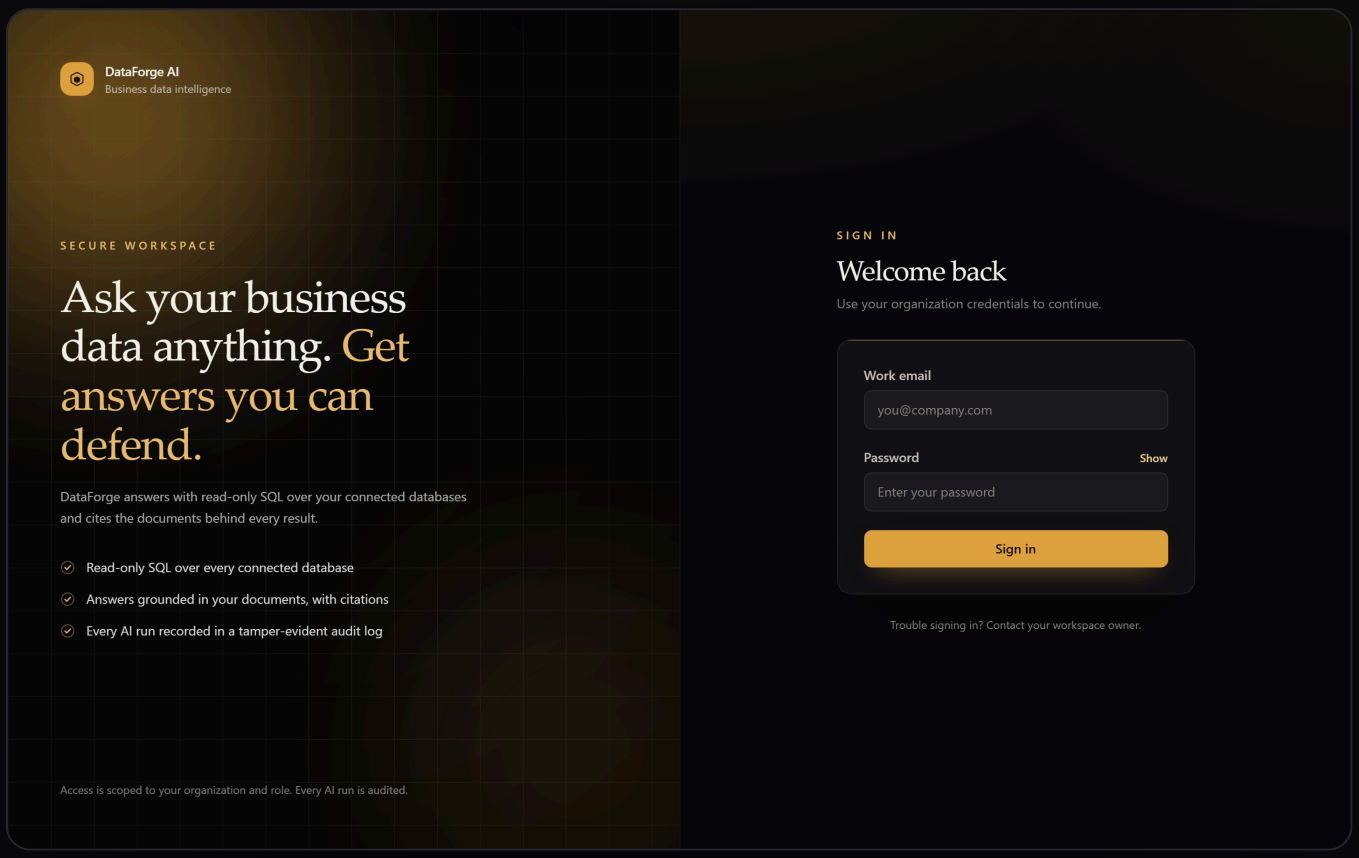
- Wait for the message **"DataForge AI is running … All six services are ready."**
- When you are finished for the day, double-click **STOP.bat** to stop the stack. Your database and uploaded documents are kept.

Prefer the command line? Run **docker compose up -d --build** and then open http://localhost:3000.

2 STEP TWO

Sign in to your workspace

Open http://localhost:3000. You will land on the sign-in page. Enter your work email and password, then select **Sign in**.

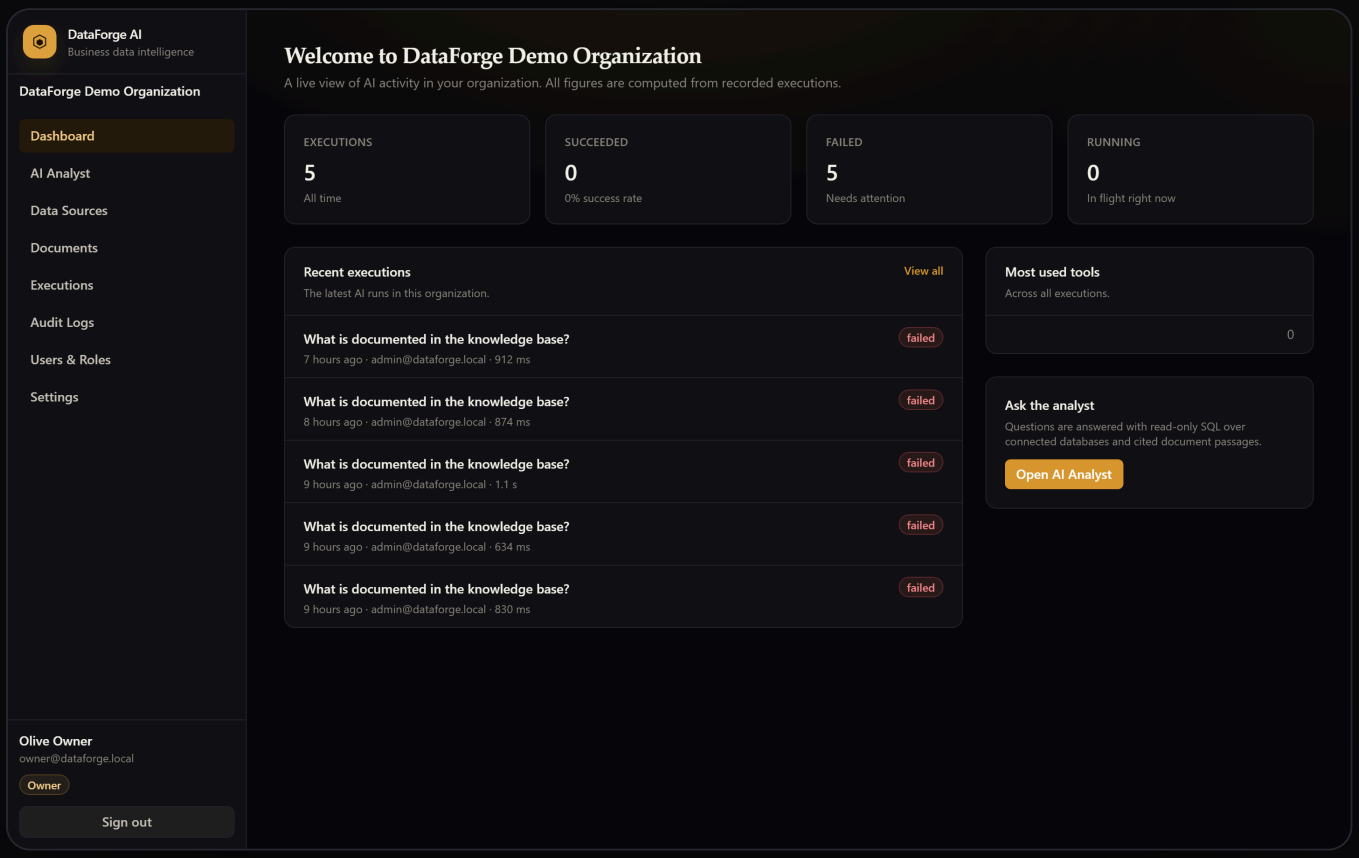


- Use the **Show / Hide** control to reveal the password while typing.
- If sign-in fails, a message appears above the fields explaining why.

3 STEP THREE

Dashboard

The dashboard is your home screen — a live view of AI activity in your organization: totals for executions, successes, failures and runs in flight, plus the most recent executions and the most-used tools.

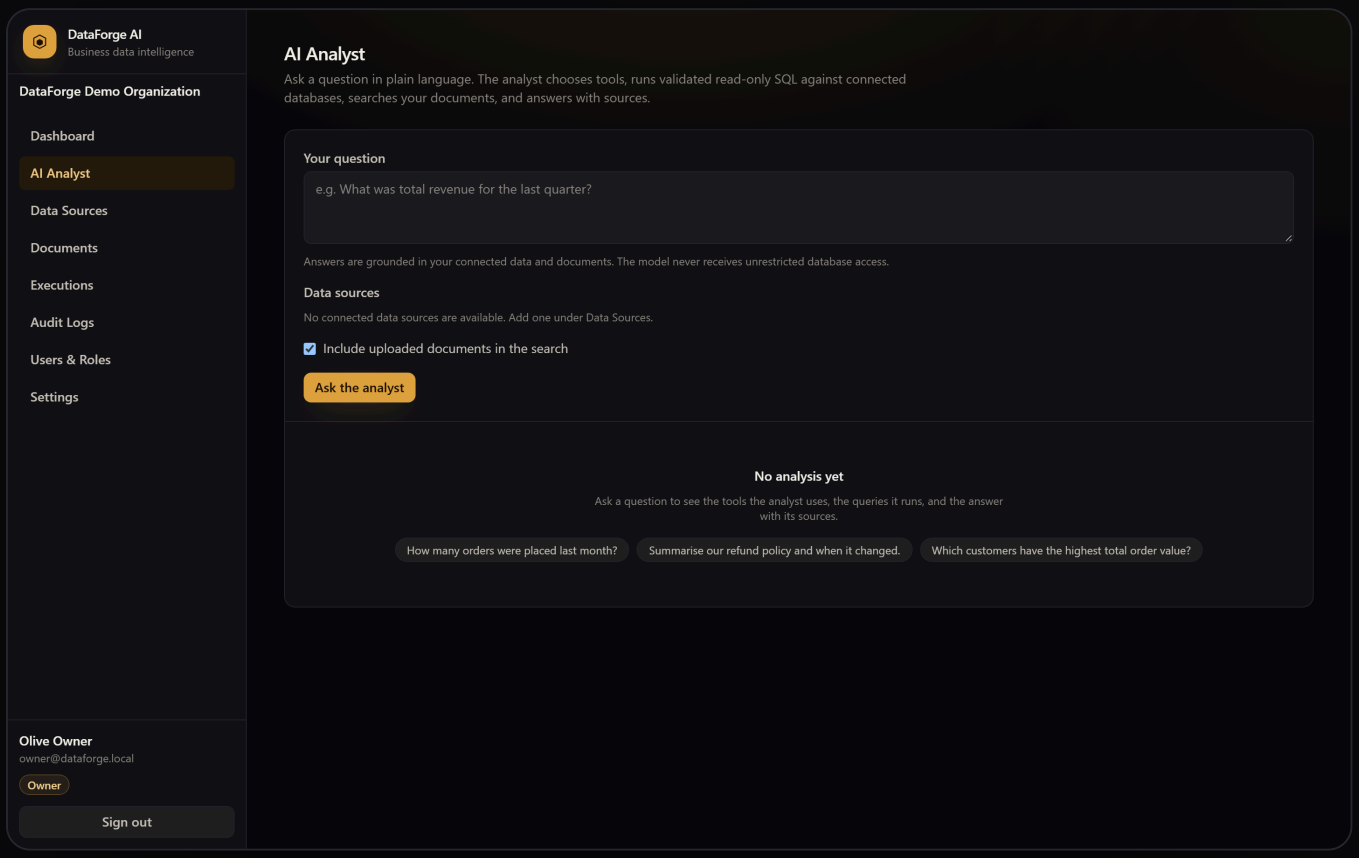


- Every figure is computed from recorded executions — nothing is estimated.
- Use the left navigation to move between the areas described next.

4 STEP FOUR

AI Analyst

Ask a question in plain language. The analyst chooses tools, runs validated read-only SQL against the connected databases, searches your documents, and answers with its sources.

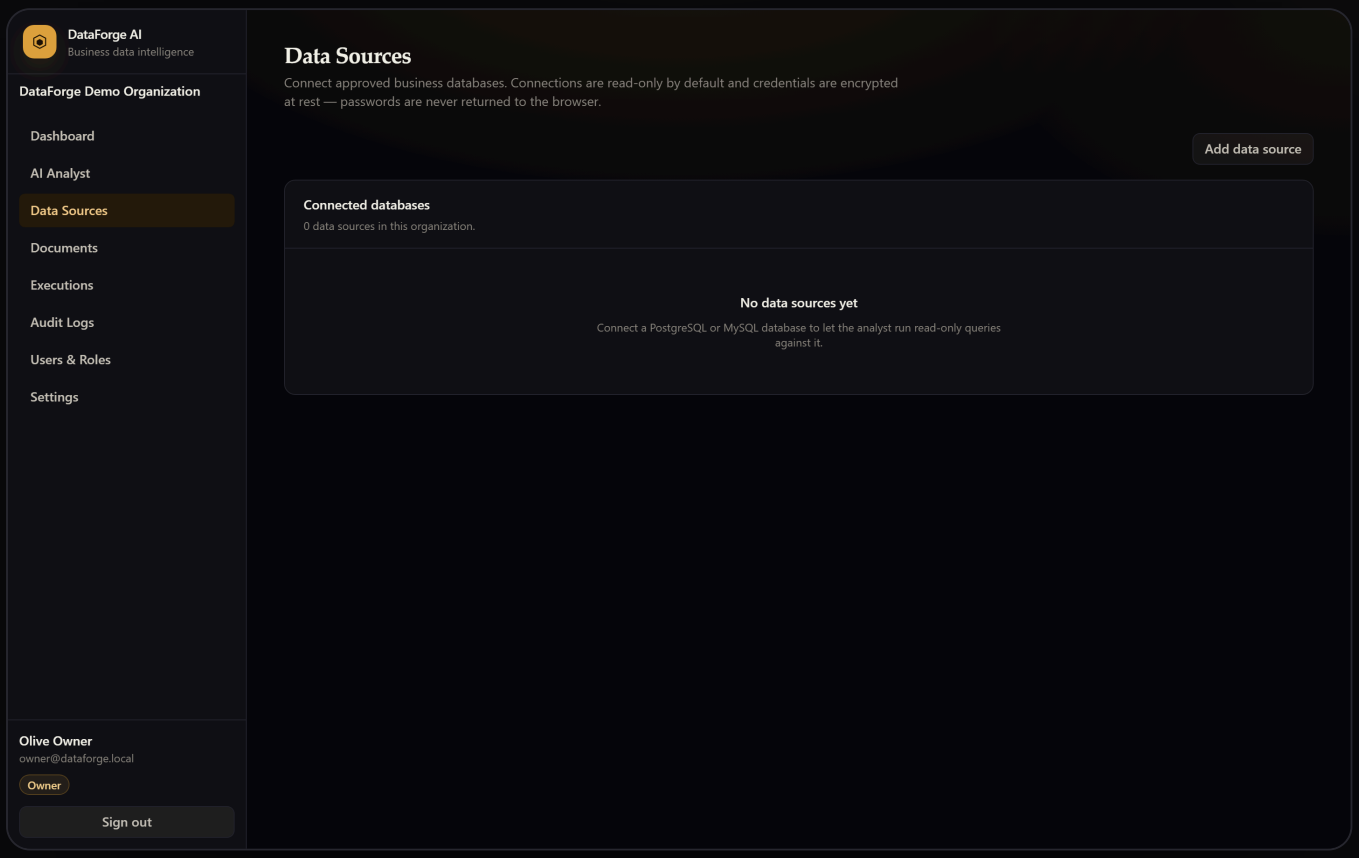


- Type your question, optionally select the data sources to use, and select **Ask the analyst**.
- Click one of the example questions to try it instantly.

5 STEP FIVE

Data Sources

Connect the business databases the analyst may read. Add a source with a read-only account, test the connection, and sync its schema so the analyst knows which tables exist.

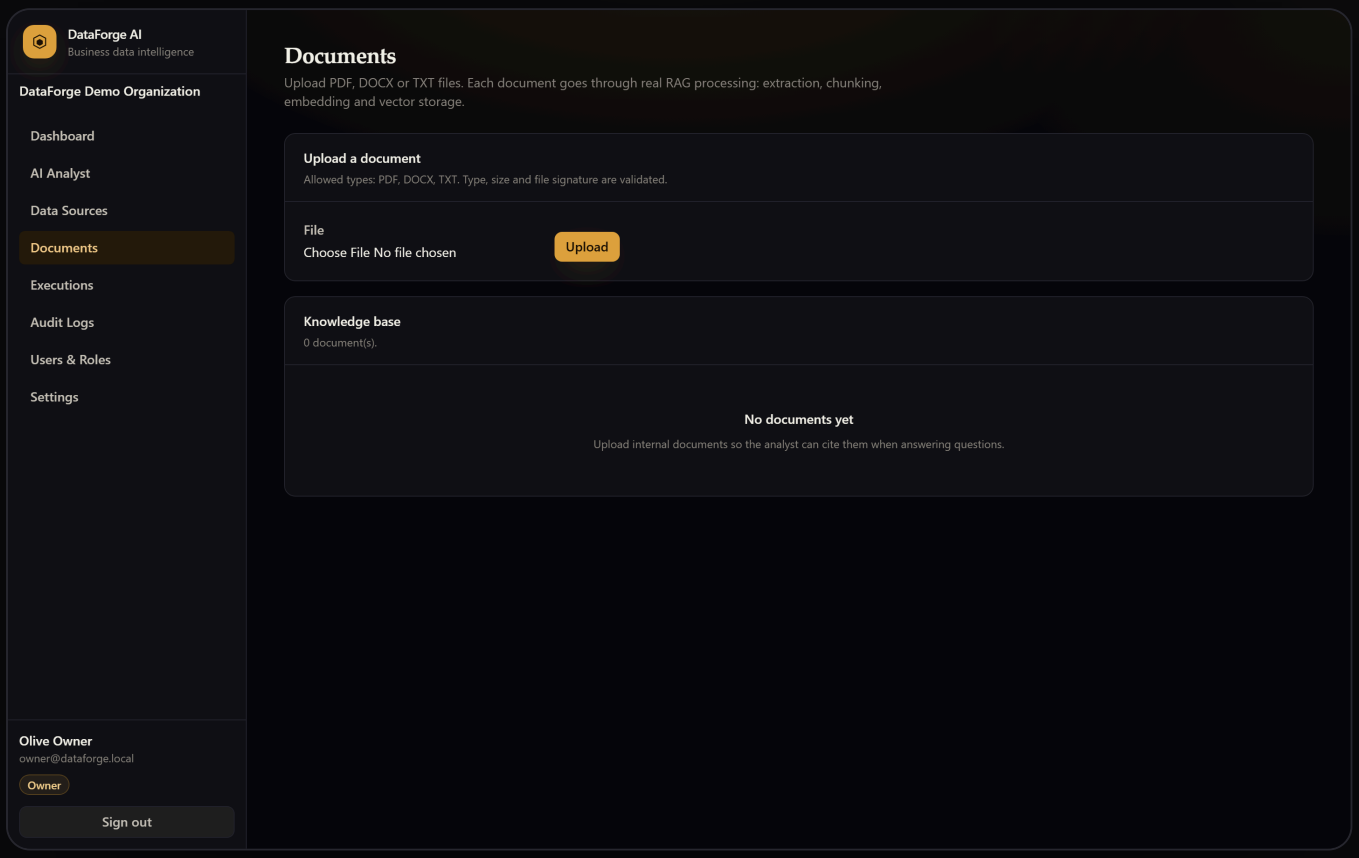


- Select **Add data source**, enter the connection details (PostgreSQL or MySQL) and create it.
- Use **Test** to verify the connection, then **Sync schema** to discover tables.
- Passwords are encrypted immediately and never returned to the browser.

6 STEP SIX

Documents

Upload internal documents (PDF, DOCX or TXT) so the analyst can cite them when answering. Processing runs in the background; the status column shows progress.

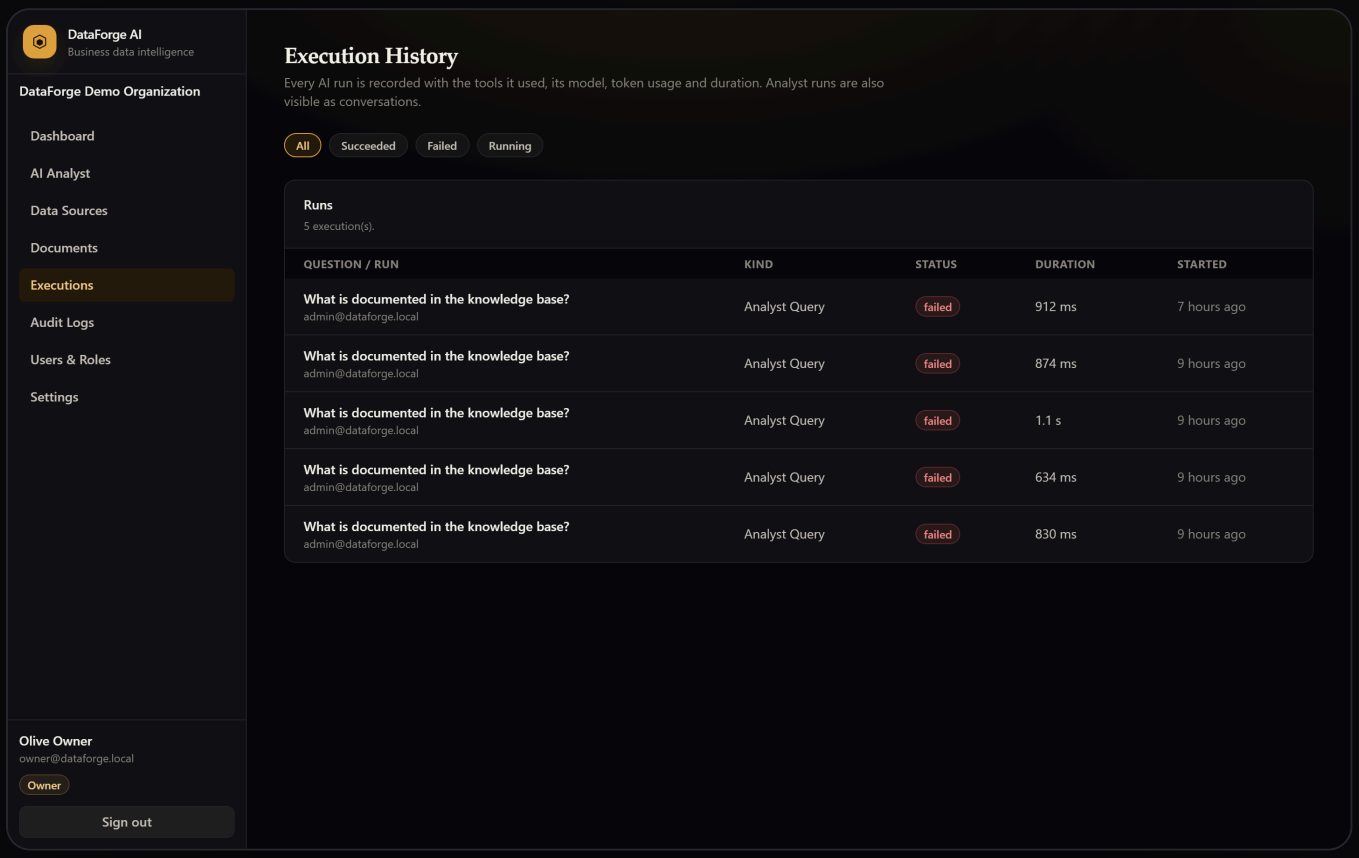


- Choose a file and select **Upload**. Refresh to watch processing complete.
- If a document fails, use **Retry** to reprocess it.

7 STEP SEVEN

Executions

Every AI run is recorded with the tools it used, its model, token usage and duration. Filter by status — All, Succeeded, Failed or Running — and select any row to open it.

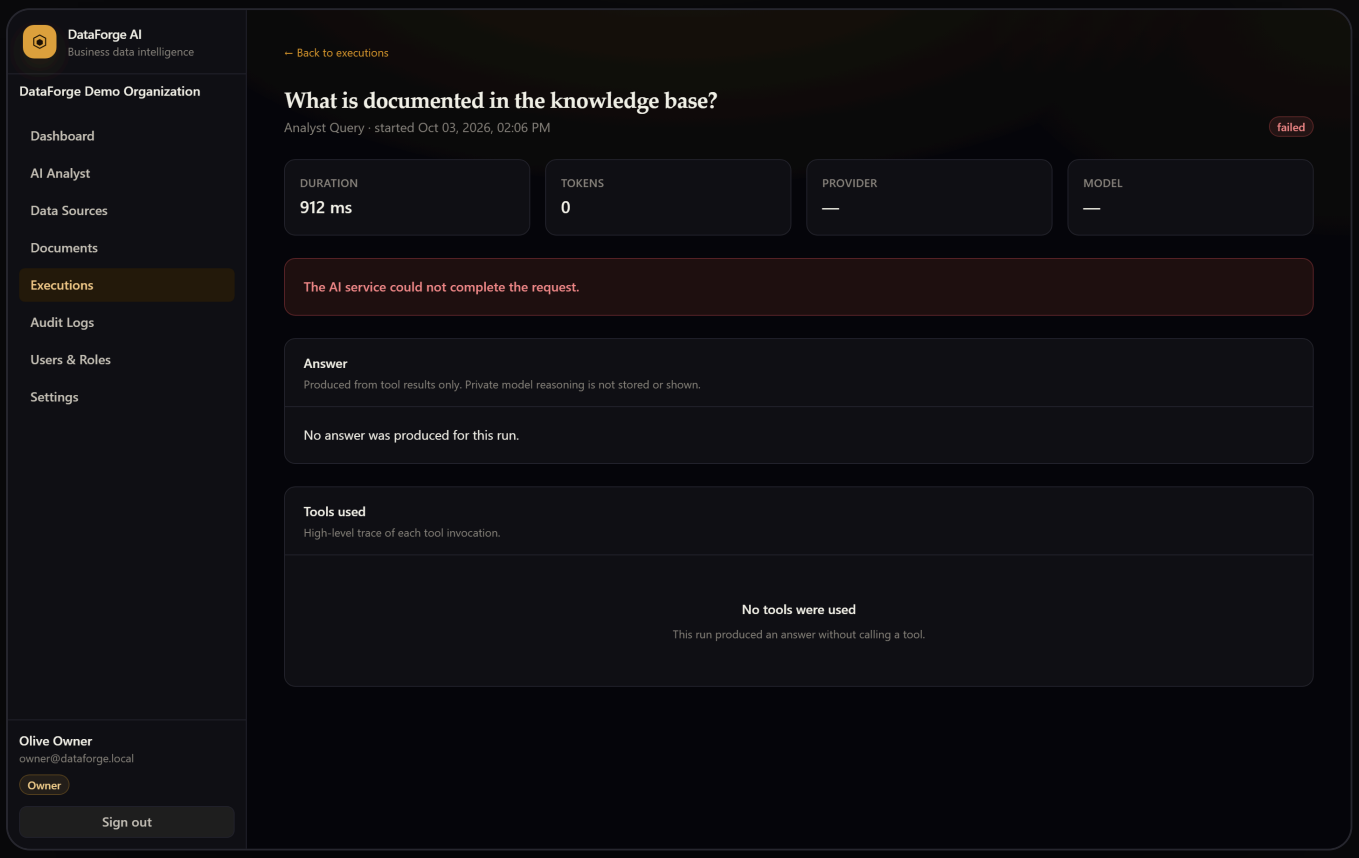


- Use the filter chips at the top to focus on failed runs that need attention.
- Select a question or run to see its full trace.

8 STEP EIGHT

Execution detail

Open a single run to see how it was answered: a summary of duration, tokens, provider and model, the answer itself, and a high-level trace of each tool invocation.

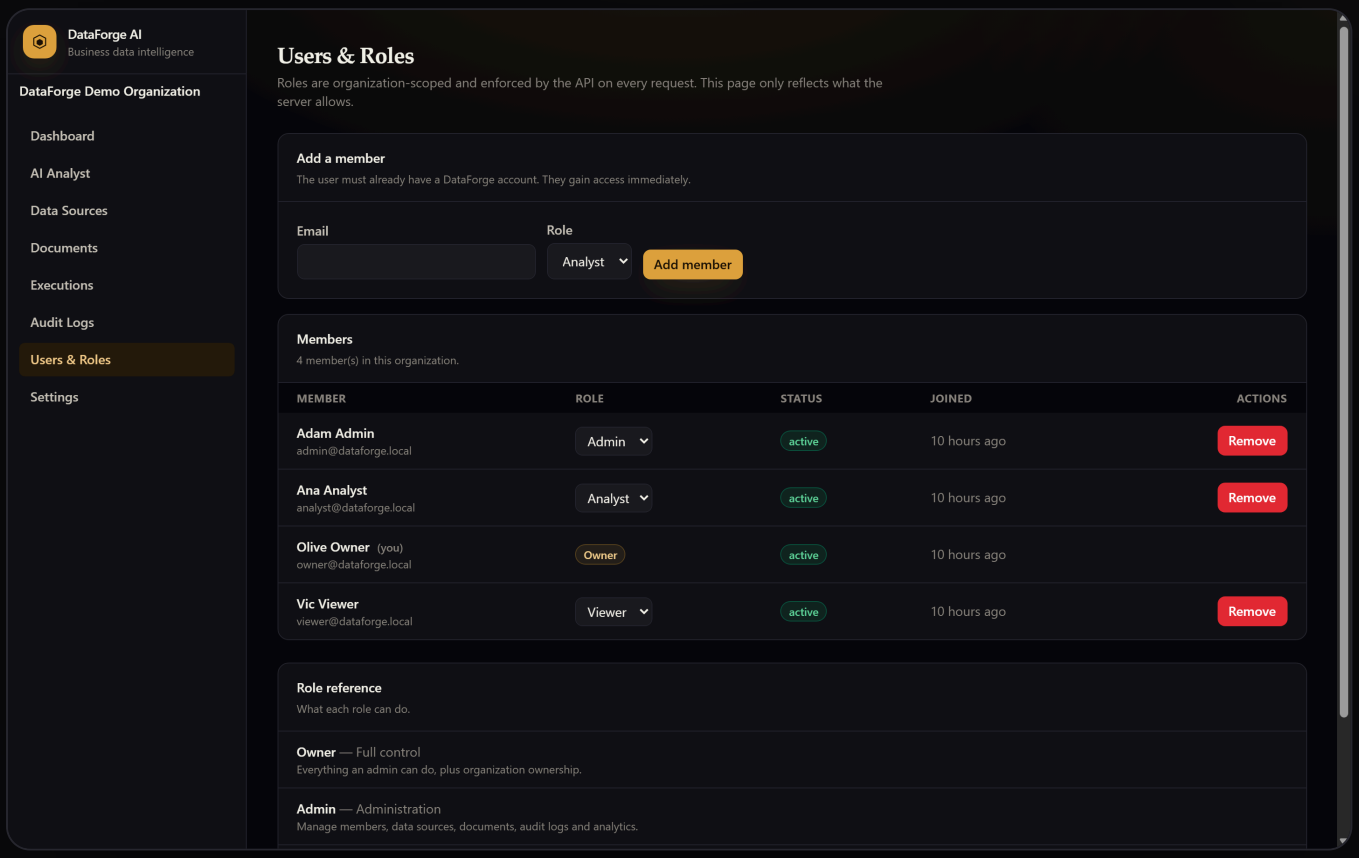


- The trace lists each step with its inputs and outputs, so you can see exactly what the analyst did.
- Private model reasoning is never stored or shown.

9 STEP NINE

Users & Roles

Manage who belongs to your organization. Add a member by email and assign a role — Owner, Admin, Analyst or Viewer. Permissions follow the role.

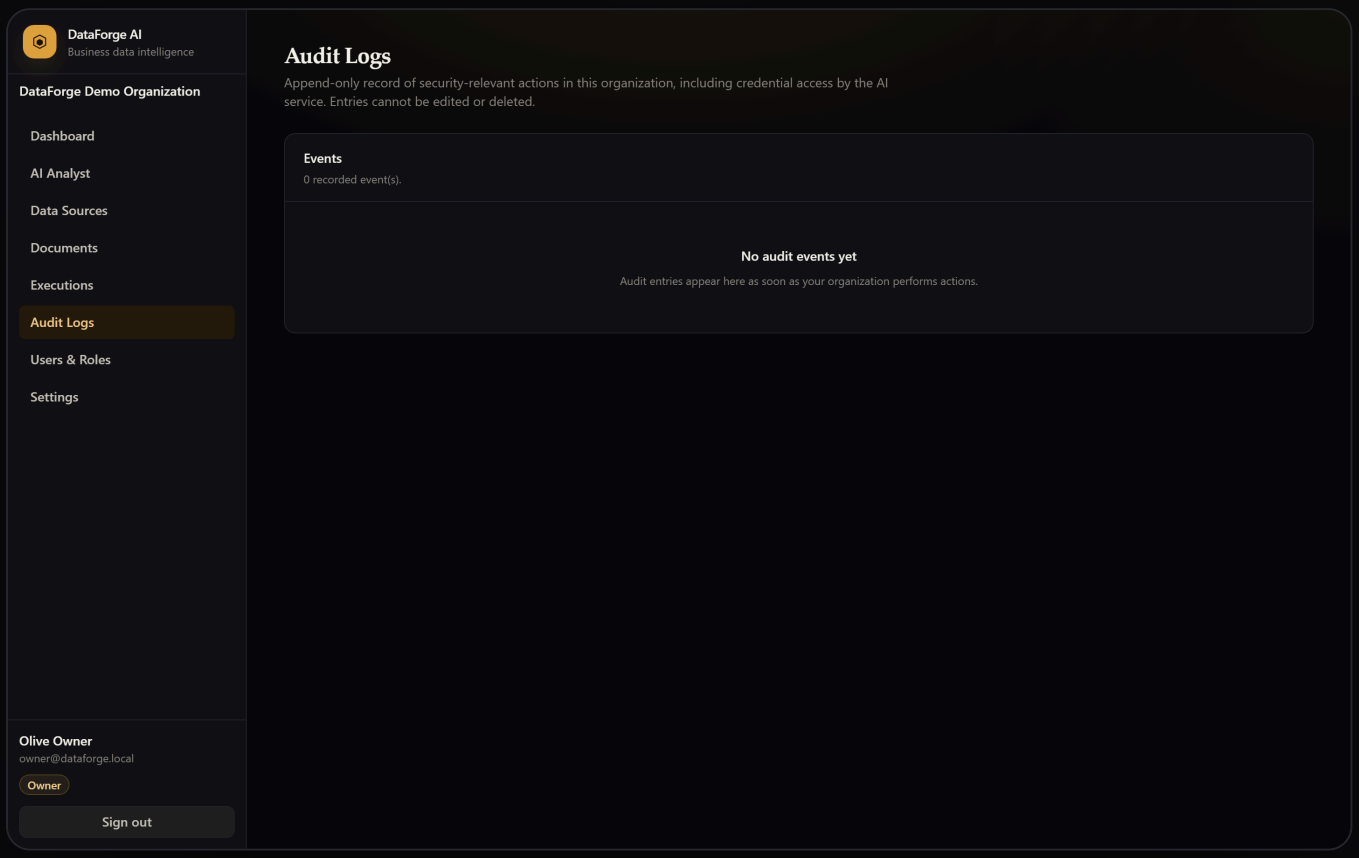


- Change a member's role inline with the role selector.
- Members with an Owner role cannot be removed from this screen.

10 STEP TEN

Audit Logs

Security-relevant events are recorded here — sign-ins, credential access, member changes and more — so you can see who did what, and when.

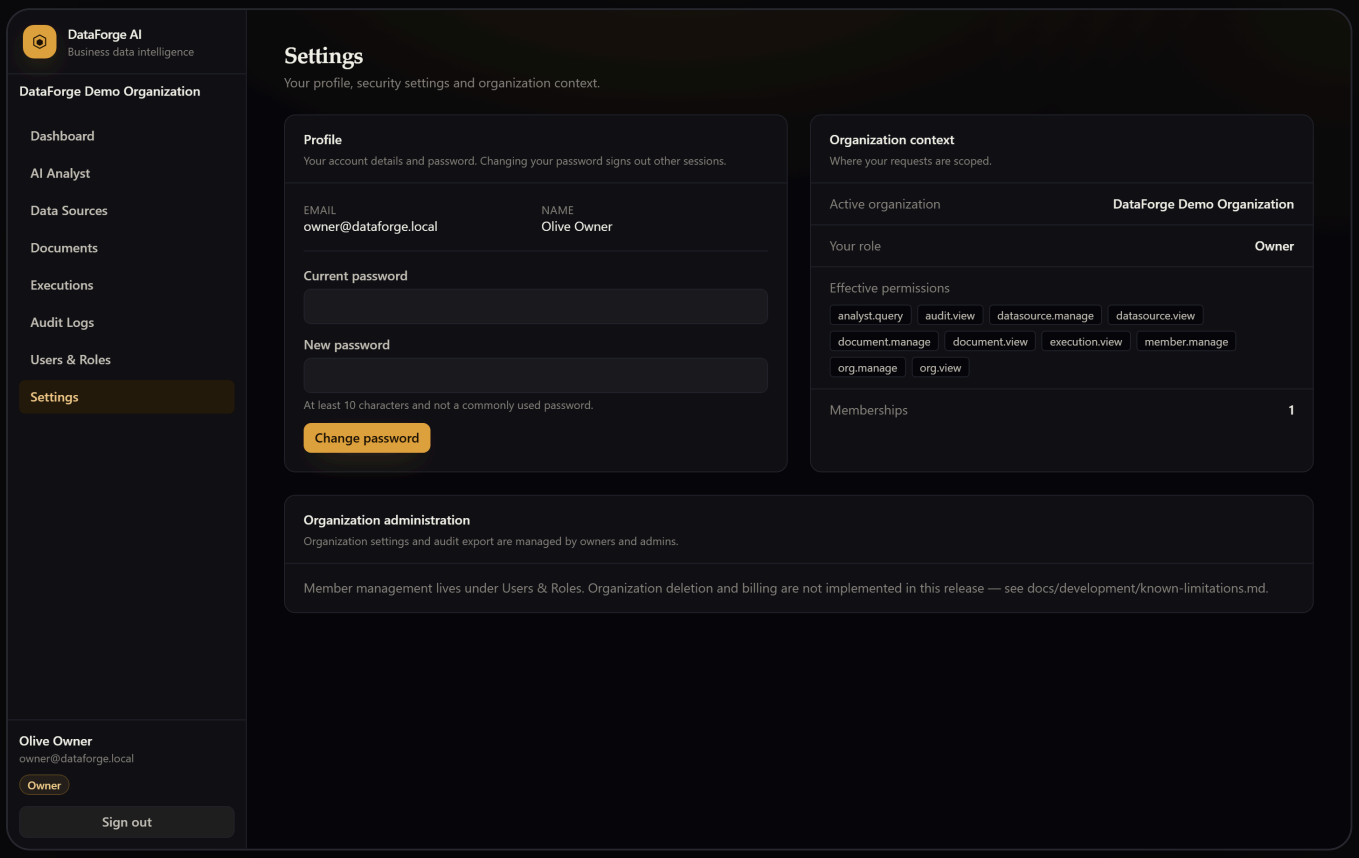


› Use the audit log to investigate access to sensitive data sources.

11 STEP ELEVEN

Settings

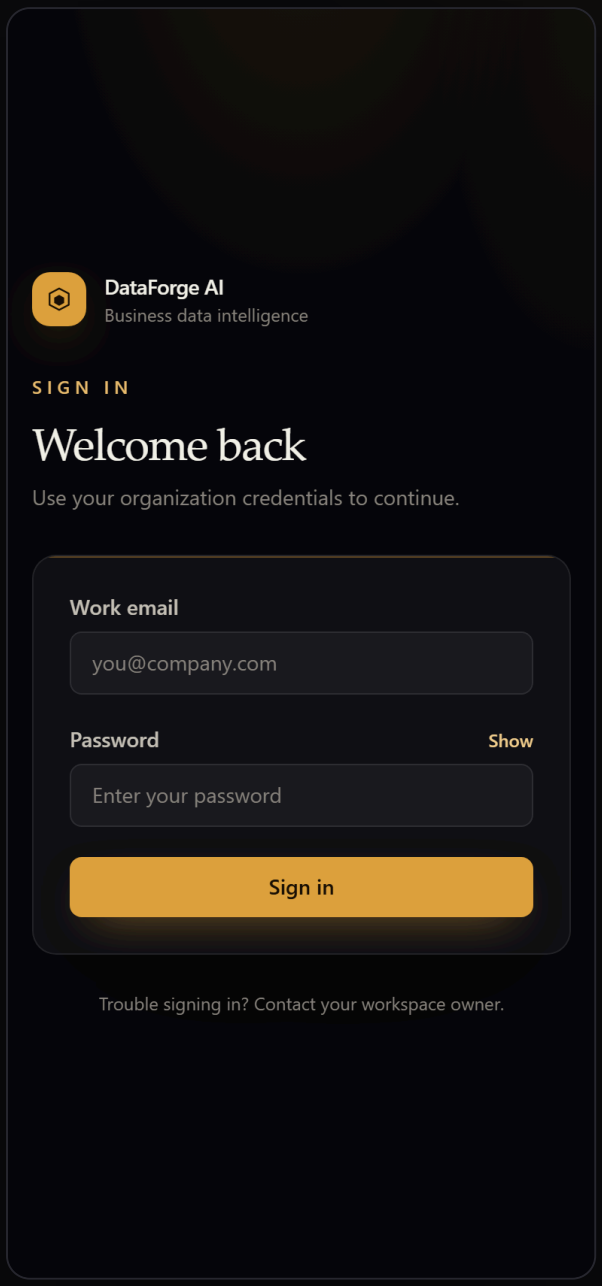
Review your account details and change your password. Changing the password signs out your other sessions for safety.



- New passwords must be at least 10 characters and not commonly used.
- Use **Sign out** at the bottom of the navigation when you are done.

12 STEP TWELVE

On mobile



The interface is fully responsive. On a phone or narrow window the top navigation collapses and the layout adapts, so you can sign in and use every screen on the go.

- Same sign-in and credentials.
- Navigation moves to a compact header.
- Tables scroll horizontally where needed.

✓ DONE

You're ready to go

You have now seen every part of DataForge AI. A typical session looks like this:

- **Start** the stack with START.bat and sign in.
- **Connect** a read-only data source and sync its schema.
- **Upload** any documents you want the analyst to cite.
- **Ask** a question in the AI Analyst and review the answer with its sources.
- **Check** Executions and Audit Logs to see what happened.
- **Stop** with STOP.bat — your data is preserved for next time.

Good to know. The AI service needs **LLM_API_KEY** and **EMBEDDING_API_KEY** in **.env** to answer analyst questions. The stack runs and every other feature works without them; analyst runs fail with a clear error until they are set.